

INTERRUPTION

Total availability means zero depth, for you and for the entire team.

How to protect the team's focus without becoming a bunker.

THE QUESTION OF THIS PIECE

An always open door is not generosity.

THE CASCADE

The two extremes that do not work.

WHAT YOU SEE

Door always open, and nobody works with depth...

THE MECHANISM

...or door always shut, and you become a bunker...

THE CONSEQUENCE

...and either way, the team loses autonomy.

Asking is always faster than deciding. That is why the open door is addictive.

THE FORK

Sort the interruption before you answer.

SORT IT FIRST

01

Client stopped or money at risk? Open door.

02

A question that can wait two hours? Door ajar.

03

Something that needs thinking together? Calendar, not interruption.

Almost everything interrupting you today would fit comfortably in the second one.

THE METHOD

The three doors.

01 **OPEN**

for what genuinely cannot wait, with written criteria

02 **AJAR**

agreed windows per day, where questions have a time

03 **CLOSED**

a protected focus block, with one clear exception and one only

| What makes all three work is the agreed response time.

IN PRACTICE, IN ORDER

Four agreements that cut interruptions.

01 • OPEN

I answer within two hours.

whoever knows the window stops poking out of insecurity

02 • AJAR

Questions go on the list, not into the hallway.

half of them resolve themselves before the window arrives

03 • CLOSED

This here is genuinely urgent.

the list of real urgencies has to fit in three items

04

Ask the team first.

the answer is usually next to them, not on your desk

TWO MODELS

Isolation or protected focus.

THE COMMON MODEL

Bunker

- Disappears with no warning
- No channel for what is urgent
- Finds out about problems late
- The team invents its own rule

THE DESIGNED MODEL

Protected focus

- Says when the door is closed
- Leaves a channel for real urgency
- Gets the problem at the ritual
- Everyone knows the rule

MISTAKE AND CONSEQUENCE

Three habits that train the team to call you.

01 Answering everything in thirty seconds.

- you teach that interrupting is the most efficient route.

02 Correcting a decision the person could have made.

- next time she asks first, out of caution.

03 Never saying how long you take to answer.

- with no known window, everyone pings early to be safe.

A repeated interruption on the same topic is a missing ceiling, not bad manners.

THE CHAIN

The repeated question test.

01

Log a week of interruptions by topic.



02

Did the same topic appear three times or more?



03

That is not an interruption, it is a missing ceiling or missing information.



WHERE LEADERSHIP STEPS IN

Fixing the cause of one recurring topic hands hours back every month.

RUN IT THIS WAY NEXT TIME

How to install the three doors.



STEP 01

Announce your response time to the team.

one sentence in the team channel does it, and behavior shifts at once



STEP 02

Create two windows a day for questions.

early morning and mid afternoon work well in most areas



STEP 03

Protect one focus block with a written exception.

and say what the exception is, or the block will not survive Tuesday

Protected focus does not push the team away, it teaches the team to decide.

THE MODEL THAT STICKS

The Three Doors, in the order that matters.



Protecting focus is not closing the door. It is agreeing when each door opens.

SAVE THIS FOR LATER

in the next week when you cannot think.

FABIO GARCIA

MANAGEMENT AS ENGINEERING
/IN/FALERCIA